2. Establish tradeoffs, and weigh pros and cons.
3. Select the best options.

4.4.1 What is a heuristic?

A *heuristic*, as defined by the Oxford English Dictionary, is “a method of solving problems by finding practical ways of dealing with them, learning from past experience.”

This is a technique of choosing a solution based on past experiences. It gives you some options on how to solve a problem; although the results are not guaranteed to be optimal, they should be good enough in most cases. It is an iterative way of working, involving trial and error.

If you want an example of a heuristic approach, think of rules of thumb. You apply them whenever it makes sense. The two-pizza rule is an excellent example of a heuristic: you should not organize a meeting for a group too large to be fed with two pizzas. It sounds reasonable, but there are clear exceptions, like a company town hall meeting.

The most simple heuristic in our case is to create a data product for every domain dataset identified in our domain.

4.4.2 Using design heuristics

You can think about heuristics as different lenses through which you can look at the same problem. When you switch lenses, you will see the problem from a different perspective and discover alternative solutions. After applying other heuristics, you will end up with different designs and generate many options. Based on these options, you can make a comparison, look for pros and cons, combine some of them to make them even more beneficial, and, in the end, hopefully make a genuinely conscious decision.

4.4.3 Designing heuristics and possible boundaries

This subsection presents the heuristics we believe are the most useful for this book’s purposes. The list is not complete, and we hope that you and your